

Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO : Mr. Tolson

DATE: 3/24/58

FROM : G. A. Neasey

Tolson _____
 Boardman _____
 Belmont _____
 Mohr _____
 Neasey _____
 Parsons _____
 Rosen _____
 Tamm _____
 Trotter _____
 Clayton _____
 Tele. Room _____
 Holloman _____
 Gandy _____

SUBJECT:

SAC Auerbach called me from Chicago Saturday night.

He stated that [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
 [REDACTED] He advised Auerbach that he had just received the transcript of a book which is being ghostwritten for Jack Webb about the Los Angeles Police Department. He told Auerbach that the Director and the Bureau were mentioned in the book and he thought we would want to take a look and see if anything was objectionable to us [REDACTED]
 [REDACTED]

b6
 b7C

[REDACTED] permitted Auerbach to Photostat the book Saturday night which was forwarded in to the Bureau and was reviewed by [REDACTED] yesterday. Attached hereto is [REDACTED] review. There appears to be nothing objectionable so far as the Bureau is concerned. It is recommended that I call Auerbach in Chicago and tell him we have no comments to make on the book [REDACTED]

GAN:hpf
 (4)
 Enclosure

cc - Mr. Rosen
 cc - Mr. Jones

EX-128

MAR 26 1958

EX-128

60 APR 1 1958

CRIME REC

FBI FILES

50 MAY 20 1958

Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO : Mr. Nease *YAK*

DATE: March 24, 1958

FROM : Mr. A. Jones *AK*

SUBJECT: "The Story of Your Police Force in Action," Los Angeles Police Dept.

Tolson _____
 Nichols _____
 Boardman _____
 Belmont _____
 Mohr _____
 Parsons _____
 Rosen _____
 Tamm _____
 Trotter _____
 Nease _____
 Tele. Room _____
 Holloman _____
 Gandy _____

In accordance with instructions from Mr. Nease, Agent Crime Records Section, yesterday secured from a Washington Field Office Agent a photostatic copy of the above-entitled. It is 291 pages long and was flown in from Chicago having been made available by

The material was reviewed, and the following points were considered of interest:

b6
b7C

(1) Page 26. States that the FBI "as matter of factly as though reporting the identity of a river floater or an auto accident victim" identified Elizabeth Short through fingerprints. You will recall that this was a case back in 1947 when through newspaper wire photo, we identified body of murder victim.

(2) Page 112. States the "LAPD believes that its Scientific Investigation Division is the finest police laboratory in the nation, differing from the superb FBI lab only in the volume of work. It is also the oldest, antedating the FBI's by seven years."

(3) Page 145. States that Tony Brancato "had won national honors by being named to the FBI's list of 'Ten Most Wanted' criminals." Anthony Brancato, Unlawful Flight to Avoid Prosecution, surrendered to the FBI when he saw his picture in the "San Francisco Call-Bulletin" on June 29, 1951.

(4) Page 172. There is a discussion concerning civil rights case which occurred in Los Angeles on Christmas Day. States as follows: "'Police Brutality' became almost a standing headline as newspapers disclosed new charges of police brutality and reported that twenty such cases had been filed with J. Edgar Hoover by the Los Angeles FBI Bureau and jury launched an investigation." This was a true case, and we did conduct an investigation.

ENCLOSURE

REC-4

62-24551-660

(CONTINUED ON NEXT PAGE)

20 MAR 26 1958

ECK:bs *bs*
(2)

EX-128

CRIME

PERS. FILES

Jones to Nease memorandum

March 24, 1958

Page 233. There is a chapter on Parker and how ^{he} became chief and states, "In his first seven years in office, the newspapers prematurely buried his Chiefship seven times, and he has been verbally attacked by politicians, minorities spokesmen, civil liberties defenders and even Mickey Cohen. He has twice been marked for assassination by gun and bomb."

Page 249. In this same chapter on Parker, there is the following: "As J. Edgar Hoover has demonstrated so brilliantly, a top enforcement authority must be more than just Superman with a badge."

b6

Page 264. There is a statement that the "LAPD's Intelligence File ranks second only to the FBI's in size and importance."

OBSERVATIONS:

This story is very complimentary of the Los Angeles Police Department and is written to show they are human beings and the problems which they have. It does this by discussing a Patrolman, a Sergeant, a Lieutenant and on up to the Chief.

There is nothing in it as far as the Bureau is concerned, and it is recommended no action be taken.

Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO : Mr. Nease *gm*

DATE: November 25, 1958

FROM : M. A. Jones *v*SUBJECT: "THE BADGE" BY JACK WEBB
MOTION PICTURE AND TV ACTOR
STAR OF THE TV PROGRAM "DRAGNET"

Tolson	_____
Boardman	_____
Belmont	_____
Mohr	_____
Nease	_____
Parsons	_____
Rosen	_____
Tamm	_____
Trotter	_____
W.C. Sullivan	_____
Tele. Room	_____
Holloman	_____
Gandy	_____

On 11-21-58, Webb sent the Director a copy of the captioned book autographed "For J. Edgar Hoover, /s/ Jack Webb." The book was sent without cover letter.

The book is written about the Los Angeles Police Department (LAPD) and some of the most challenging cases solved by that law enforcement agency. Webb acts as a narrator in describing these cases and, of course, it is quite flattering to the LAPD.

The FBI is mentioned in several places in the book but not in a derogatory manner. The usual reference to the Bureau is a reference to the Identification Division where the fingerprint record of criminals is checked by the LAPD. Bufiles reflect no correspondence from Webb and no relations with him. In June, 1955, a Warner ⁸⁴⁷² official called the Bureau stating that Webb would be in Washington in August and desired to meet the Director. George Fishman of Warner Brothers was informed that the Director was in a travel status and would not be able to see Webb. b6

RECOMMENDATION:

That the attached letter be sent to Jack Webb. ¹¹⁻²¹⁻⁵⁸ *gm*
letter, not be acknowledged.

Enclosure

JK:sfc
(2)

REC-21

EX-136

12 NOV 28 1958

DEC 10 1958 *n.r.*

62-24550-669

94-51307

910

p5

Mr. Nease

Page 112--This was a statement that the Los Angeles Police Department's Scientific Investigation Division was the finest police laboratory in the nation, differing from the superb FBI lab only in the volume of work. This was not considered derogatory and we did not object.

Page 149--This states that the FBI used an individual as a professional decoy. On the copy of the book we had this had already been deleted.

Page 172--This is a discussion concerning civil rights cases that broke in Los Angeles and states that the "cases had been filed with J. Edgar Hoover by the Los Angeles FBI Bureau." This was done and we did not object.

b6
b7C

Page 219--This is the case of [redacted] The sentence "The FBI moved in to plug escape routes across state lines" is not objectionable as far as we were concerned. It is noted it is being deleted.

Page 264--The Los Angeles Police Department's Intelligence File ranks second only to the FBI's in size and importance. We did not feel we should object to this. It is noted it is being deleted.

From substance of the above it appears that we are being deleted in four places in the book. The others are not considered in any way objectionable.

RECOMMENDATION:

For information.

*file
4
ch*



*- with this I
certainly agree.
G*

2 -

*577
we are asking SAC Brown
at Los Angeles whether
states to him as was*

b6

26 Next day, as matter of fact as though reporting the identity of a river floater or an auto accident victim, the FBI supplied the who.

day the FBI supplied the who.

80 As part of his own preparation, he constantly carried fifty mug shots in his pocket, whipping them out every now and then to memorize the scowling faces. At the end of the three months, he had memorized another 1,500 faces, and in tribute to him, the PX code name when a cop was wanted was [redacted] Even the FBI adopted it.

Delete the last sentence

b6
b7C

102 When [redacted] arrived in town, the ladies were overwhelmed. He had the courtly manners of a count and, what counts don't always have, money, too, being by reputation a landed gentleman. There was also a dash of the virile about; not one of those decadent counts, you know. He had been an FBI agent, and now he was in Hollywood as a technical adviser on an FBI picture.

He had been an FBI agent, he told t and now he was in Hollywood as a technical adviser on an FBI picture

112 LAPD believes that its Scientific Investigation Division is the finest police laboratory in the nation, differing from the superb FBI lab only in the volume of work.

LAPD's Scientific Investigation Division is the finest police laboratory in the nation, differing from the superb FBI lab only in the volume of work.

149 Through his own mysterious channels, the captain made contact with a suave France soldier-of-fortune who sometimes hired out to big-city police and even the FBI as a professional decoy.

Delete: "and even the FBI"

172 At least, that was the story, though precisely what did happen has never been fully established. Parker and LAPD were subjected to attacks which continued for months. Six of the young celebrants were freed by a judge who denounced "lawless law enforcement." "Police Brutality" became almost a standing headline as newspapers disclosed new charges of police brutality and reported that twenty such cases had been filed with J. Edgar Hoover by the Los Angeles FBI Bureau. The grand jury launched an investigation.

At least, that was the story, though precisely what did happen has never been fully established. Parker and L were subjected to attacks which continued for months. Six of the young celebrants were freed by a judge who denounced "lawless law enforcement." "Police Brutality" became almost a standing headline. The grand jury launched an investigation.

219 But except for a few tire tracks that was all [redacted] had to go on. By morning he had twenty detectives checking all Modus Operandi cards, questioning and requestioning the Melchiors, searching and researching the grounds. The FBI moved in to plug escape routes across state lines.

Delete last sentence.

264 From one end of the country to the other, Intelligence amassed detailed dossiers on every important mobster in the U. S., many of whom never had seen Los Angeles and probably never would. Parker felt that in an airplane age when cities are only minutes apart, the long job of interviewing and corresponding with police and crime commissions from Main to Florida was worth the time and expense. Today LAPD's Intelligence File ranks second only to the FBI's in size and importance.

Delete last sentence.

ST *Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT*

TO : Mr. Tolson

DATE: May 7, 1958

FROM : G. A. Nease *ga*

SUBJECT:

*Police Department -
Los Angeles Calif.*

Tolson	_____
Boardman	_____
Belmont	_____
Mohr	_____
Nease	_____
Parsons	_____
Rosen	_____
Tamm	_____
Trotter	_____
Clayton	_____
Tele. Room	_____
Holloman	_____
Gandy	_____

b6

With reference to the Director's conversation with [redacted] concerning the Jack Webb book, I have checked with Los Angeles. ASAC Bachman checked with SAC Brown when Brown called in this afternoon; Brown presently being at the home of his father in Arizona who is ill. It was SAC Brown's recollection that [redacted] had mentioned to him on the phone that he had shown a manuscript to SAC Auerbach in Chicago and that it has been returned to him and that we had no suggestions to make in connection with it. SAC Brown does not recall that [redacted] ever mentioned the name of the book but he believes it was the Jack Webb book. SAC Brown never reviewed the manuscript or had it in his possession. It, therefore, appears that [redacted] had SAC Auerbach in mind when he talked to the Director.

As a matter of interest, SAC Brown stated that he understands this book, known as "Badge," will be released this fall by Prentis Hall Publishing Company.

GAN:saks *SR*
(2)

✓ *pm* *file 4*

REC-11

EX-105

62-24550-662

MAY 16 1958

50 MAY 20 1958 *4/14/58*

PERS. FILES

st *esa* Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO : Mr. Nease

DATE: May 7, 1958

FROM : M. A. Jones

Tolson _____
Boardman _____
Belmont _____
Mohr _____
Nease _____
Parsons _____
Rosen _____
Tamm _____
Trotter _____
Clayton _____
Tele. Room _____
Holloman _____
Gandy _____

SUBJECT: [REDACTED]

"THE STORY OF YOUR POLICE
FORCE IN ACTION"

Reference is made to the attached green tickler which sets forth certain comments concerning the above-entitled matter.

Text of this book which was 200 pages long was sent to us on March 23, 1958, by SAC Auerbach in Chicago. Auerbach stated that he had received the transcript of the book which was being ghostwritten for Jack Webb about the Los Angeles Police Department from [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] *MANUSCRIPT* permitted Auerbach to make a Photostat of the book which was sent to the Bureau, immediately reviewed, and decided that there was nothing in the book which we should make any objections to as it was not derogatory. COPY OF MEMO ATTACHED.

Briefly, the book is a story of the Los Angeles Police Department written to show they are human beings and the problems which they have. Chapter by chapter it discusses a patrolman, a sergeant, and lieutenant and up to the Chief of Police. Our memorandum of review is attached.

To take up the points specifically mentioned it is noted as follows:

Page 26--This refers to the identification made of Elizabeth Short by the Identification Division. This was a 1947 case. She was commonly known as the Black Dahlia. We had no objection to this.

Page 80--This refers to a type of personal appearance file which is used by us and was not considered to be objectionable. It was noted but not mentioned in our original review. It was considered a very minor point.

Page 102--This is a case of an arch criminal in Los Angeles who preyed upon women and used every trick in the book to relieve them of their jewels and money. It was not felt that this was derogatory to the Bureau in that con men often adopt the romantic guise of an FBI Agent.

Enclosures

1-Mr. Nease

ECK:grs

(5)

REC- 11

EX-101

EX-101
ENCLOSURE
MAY 20 1958

MAY 16 1958

62-24550-
MAY 16 1958